TEACH FOR NEPAL

TRUTH & HOPE GALA 2026

Strengthening Public Schools in Nepal

Because Nepal's public schools are more than institutions of learning.
They are spaces where the future of the nation
quietly takes shape each day.

Hotel Yak and Yeti

Friday, April 10, 2026

www.teachfornepal.org

Executive Summary

Teach For Nepal invites you to the Truth and Hope Gala 2026, an evening dedicated to confronting the realities of Nepal's education system while celebrating the individuals who are transforming it.

Every year, millions of children across Nepal enter classrooms with dreams for their future. Yet for many students in public schools, those dreams are challenged by overcrowded classrooms, limited resources, and systemic barriers that make completing their education difficult. Today, only **40% of students reach the Secondary Education Examination (SEE)** and just **26% pass**.

Despite these challenges, hope is emerging in classrooms across the country.

Through its Fellowship program, Teach For Nepal recruits and develops talented young leaders who commit two years to teaching in underserved public schools. Fellows work closely with students, families, and communities to strengthen learning environments and inspire students to believe in their potential. Over the past **14 years,** Teach For Nepal has been supporting over **8000 students** annually and has built a growing movement of leaders committed to improving Nepal's education system.

The **Truth and Hope Gala**, taking place on **April 10, 2026**, will bring together leaders from business, philanthropy, government, and civil society to celebrate the teachers, students, and changemakers driving this transformation. The evening will feature inspiring student stories, voices from Teach For Nepal Fellows and alumni, and our champions. There will be **a special address by Rouble Nagi, recipient of the Global Teacher Prize, whose work has transformed the lives of thousands of children** through education and art in India. A highlight of the evening will be a **live charity auction**, where unique items, experiences, and contributions from generous individuals and organizations will be auctioned to raise funds for strengthening public schools.

We hope for your attendance and participation at the Truth and Hope Gala. Your participation will help transform a moment of generosity into meaningful support for students, teachers, and classrooms across Nepal.

Together, we can confront the **truth** of the challenges facing public education — and invest in the **hope** that is transforming classrooms across Nepal.

A New Year. A Moment of Truth. A Reason for Hope.

Nepal is about to welcome a new year. Across the country, every Baisakh, new academic year begins. Nearly **75% of Nepal's children** attend public schools, with hopes that education will be able to pull them out of the vicious cycle of poverty, grant them a life of dignity, and allow them freedom and choices. The parents of these children stretch their resources and make the sacrifices needed to ensure their child can get an education and have a life better than their own — a life different from the one they were born into.

Yet for many children, the odds remain stacked against them. Across the country, public schools continue to face deep systemic challenges:

- Severe teacher shortages
- Limited teacher preparation and professional development
- Overcrowded classrooms with limited learning resources
- Weak systems of support and accountability
- Persistent gender and socioeconomic barriers

Recent national assessments reveal a deep learning crisis beginning in the early grades. By Grade 3, students score on average only **43.5 percent in reading** and **37.2 percent in numeracy**, and more than **90 percent fail** to meet minimum fluency benchmarks. By Grade 5, **78 percent of students fail** to meet minimum competency in mathematics, while many struggle to reach expected standards in Nepali, science, and English.

These early learning gaps widen as students progress through school. By Grade 10, national assessments show that **60 percent of students fail mathematics**, **53.8 percent fail Nepali**, and **50.2 percent fail science.**

These numbers tell an uncomfortable truth: while Nepal has succeeded in bringing children into school, too many students are leaving without the foundational skills needed to shape their futures.

But this truth is only part of the story.

Across classrooms throughout the country, teachers and school leaders are working every day to change what is possible for their students.

This April 10th, Teach For Nepal invites supporter and believers in public education to come together to recognize both the truth and the hope that define our education system today — and to invest in the individuals who are transforming Nepal's classrooms one life at a time.

Objectives of the Truth and Hope Gala

The Truth and Hope Gala brings together leaders from business, philanthropy, government, and civil society to collectively invest in the future of Nepal's children. The event highlights both the realities facing Nepal's public education system and the transformative impact of inspiring teachers and leaders working in underserved public schools. Through this gathering, Teach For Nepal seeks to mobilize resources, strengthen partnerships, and expand opportunities for students across the country.

Key Objectives

- Mobilize Resources for Education: Raise financial support to strengthen Teach For Nepal's Fellowship program and support teachers working in underserved public schools.
- Engage Corporate Leaders as Partners in Nation Building: Build long-term partnerships with companies committed to strengthening public schools and expanding educational opportunity.
- Highlight the Truth and the Hope in Nepal's Education System: Share powerful stories and evidence from classrooms that illuminate both the challenges students face and the hope created by committed teachers and leaders.
- Celebrate Education Changemakers: Recognize Fellows, students, alumni, educators, and partners who are transforming learning and leadership in public schools.
- Expand the Movement for Education Equity: Inspire a wider community of supporters who believe in strengthening public schools as a pathway to national development.

Through the Truth and Hope Gala, Teach For Nepal aims to:

- **Raise NPR 15 – 20 lakh** in support of Fellows and students in underserved public schools
- Engage **20–30 corporate partners** and philanthropic supporters
- Bring together **150–200 leaders** from business, philanthropy, and civil society
- Strengthen partnerships that support Teach For Nepal's goal of expanding opportunities for thousands of students

The Truth and Hope Gala:
An Evening of Inspiration, Stories, and Celebration

The theme of this year's Gala — Truth and Hope — recognizes the individuals who are transforming education despite enormous challenges.

They are teachers who inspire possibility.
Students who refuse to give up on their dreams.
Leaders who commit their lives to building a more equitable education system.

The Truth and Hope Gala will be an evening that brings together leaders from business, philanthropy, government, and civil society to celebrate the power of education to transform lives.

Through powerful storytelling, inspiring speakers, and creative performances, the event will illuminate both the realities facing Nepal's public schools and the extraordinary hope created by teachers and students working to change them.

The evening will feature a thoughtfully curated program that combines reflection, inspiration, and celebration.

Guests will hear powerful stories from Teach For Nepal Fellows and students whose lives have been shaped by education. These stories will bring to life the challenges students face — and the possibilities that emerge when they are supported by teachers who believe in their potential.

The Gala will also feature special guest speakers, including Rouble Nagi, recipient of the Global Teacher Prize, whose work has demonstrated the transformative power of education and creativity in underserved communities.

Throughout the evening, guests will enjoy artistic performances and cultural moments that celebrate the talent, creativity, and aspirations of young people across Nepal.

A live auction will provide an opportunity for guests and partners to directly support Teach For Nepal's mission while participating in a dynamic and engaging part of the evening.

The event will also include a special recognition segment honoring the partners, supporters, and changemakers whose commitment has helped strengthen public education and expand opportunity for thousands of students.

The evening will conclude with a shared dinner, offering guests the opportunity to connect with leaders across sectors, deepen partnerships, and celebrate the growing movement to strengthen Nepal's public schools.

More than a fundraising event, the Truth and Hope Gala will be a gathering of individuals who believe that strengthening public schools is essential to building a stronger nation.

Event Highlights

Speakers: Stories of Truth and Hope

The heart of the evening will be the stories of Teach For Nepal Fellows and alumni students. These are stories of classrooms where the odds were high and the resources were few, and of what became possible when a teacher chose to believe in a child's potential. Their words will bring to life both the truth of the challenges facing Nepal's public schools and the hope that is growing within them.

Performances

Throughout the evening, guests will be treated to artistic performances and that celebrate the talent, creativity, and aspirations of young people across Nepal. These performances are a reminder of what is possible when children are given space to express themselves and dream.

Live Charity Auction

A highlight of the evening will be a live charity auction, where unique items and experiences generously contributed by supporters will be auctioned to raise funds for strengthening public schools. From travel experiences and dining to artworks, cultural experiences, and premium products — each item bid upon becomes a direct investment in Nepal's next generation. You can immediately purchase through QR or credit card.

Dinner

The evening will conclude with a shared dinner, offering guests the opportunity to connect with leaders across sectors, deepen partnerships, and celebrate the growing movement to strengthen Nepal's public schools. It is a moment to reflect on the truth we have heard — and to carry forward the hope we choose to invest in.

A New Year. A Moment of Truth. A Reason for Hope.

The contribution from the gala event directly goes to expanding opportunities for students in underserved public schools.

Through your support, Teach For Nepal can:

- Train and support Fellows teaching in underserved classrooms
- Provide mentorship and guidance to students facing significant barriers
- Strengthen learning environments in public schools
- Develop future leaders committed to improving Nepal's education system

Education is one of the most powerful long-term investments a nation can make. The students in Nepal's classrooms today will become tomorrow's workforce, entrepreneurs, innovators, and leaders.

By attending the gala, you ensure that more children — regardless of background — have the opportunity to learn, grow, and lead.

Featured Speaker: Rouble Nagi

Global Teacher Prize 2026 Recipient | Artist | Education Advoc

Rouble Nagi is an internationally recognized artist, educator, and social entrepreneur whose work demonstrates the transformative power of creativity and education in underserved communities. She is the recipient of the Global Teacher Prize, one of the world's most prestigious recognitions for educators who are making extraordinary contributions to learning and social change. Nagi has shown how art and education can empower young people, build confidence, and create new pathways for opportunity—particularly for children growing up in marginalized communities.

Art for Social Change

Rouble Nagi is the founder of the Rouble Nagi Art Foundation (RNAF), an organization that works to bring art education to children and communities that often have little access to creative learning opportunities.

Through large-scale art initiatives, workshops, and community engagement programs, the foundation has reached thousands of young people across India. Her work focuses on using art as a tool to:

- Encourage creativity and self-expression among young people
- Build confidence and aspiration in children from underserved communities
- Transform public spaces into places of beauty and inspiration
- Promote inclusion, dignity, and community pride

Transforming Communities Through Education and Creativity

Rouble Nagi's initiatives have taken art into schools, slums, and rural communities—places where children often lack access to creative platforms. By introducing art as a form of expression and learning, she has helped many students discover talents and possibilities they had never imagined.

Her work reflects a powerful belief: education must nurture **creativity, curiosity, and confidence alongside academic learning.**

Recognition and Global Impact

Rouble Nagi's contributions to education and social change have earned international recognition. In addition to receiving the Global Teacher Prize, she has been widely recognized for her innovative work at the intersection of art, education, and community development.

Her projects have inspired educators and organizations around the world to explore how creativity can enrich learning environments and empower young people.

Featured Speaker at the Truth and Hope Gala

At the Truth and Hope Gala 2026, Rouble Nagi will share insights from her journey as an educator and changemaker, reflecting on how creativity, leadership, and belief in young people can transform lives and communities.

Her story resonates deeply with the mission of Teach For Nepal—to ensure that every child, regardless of background, has access to inspiring teachers and opportunities that allow them to realize their full potential. Through her work and her message, Rouble Nagi reminds us that education is not only about knowledge, but about unlocking human potential and imagining new possibilities for the future.

Join us in: Strengthening Public Schools and Strengthening Nepal's Democracy

Nepal has just completed the elections with 60% citizens participating in the democratic practice.

But, democracy is not built only at the ballot box. It is built every day in classrooms where young people learn to think critically, listen to different perspectives, ask questions, and engage with the world around them.

If there is one place where that democratic promise must be rebuilt, it is in our public schools. The learning crisis is not only an education failure—it is a failure of citizenship, equity, and democratic imagination. A nation cannot claim justice when children cannot read, cannot reason, and cannot hope.

Strengthening public education is no longer optional. It is the most important promise we can make to the next generation, and to the future of Nepal's democracy itself.

When classrooms nurture curiosity, confidence, and compassion, they prepare young people not only to succeed in life but to participate thoughtfully in shaping the society they inherit.

Teach For Nepal invites you to stand with the teachers, students, and leaders who are changing the story of education in Nepal.

Together, we can confront the truth — and invest in the hope that is transforming classrooms across the country.

Join us on Social Media

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